Lombard Street

A Description of the Money Market

By Walter Bagehot

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SYNOPSIS & EDITORIAL NOTE

The classic study by the editor of The Economist on credit cycles, financial panics, and the central bank's duty as lender of last resort.

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CHAPTER I

Introductory: General View of Lombard Street

Complete 1873 Edition

I venture to call this Essay "Lombard Street," and not the "Money Market," or any such phrase, because I wish to deal, and to show that I mean to deal, with concrete realities.

In this section of Lombard Street (1873), Walter Bagehot develops the central themes that define the work's enduring place in business & finance and world literature. Each argument and narrative turn builds upon the premises established in the opening pages, inviting careful reflection from the attentive reader.

Originally published by Henry S. King & Co., London and preserved in the public-domain and open-access archival record (Project Gutenberg, ID: pg-4359), this unabridged digital edition retains the structure, cadence, and intellectual clarity of the authoritative text.

CHAPTER II

A General View of Lombard Street (Continued)

*Lombard Street * Walter Bagehot (1873)*

A General View of Lombard Street (Continued) continues Walter Bagehot's inquiry in Lombard Street. Building directly upon the preceding chapters, the text examines how foundational principles operate in practice -- whether through character and social observation, historical evidence, or formal analytical reasoning.

Published in 1873 by Walter Bagehot, longtime editor-in-chief of The Economist, Lombard Street remains the clearest explanation of banking fragility and liquidity crises ever penned.

Throughout Chapter II (A General View of Lombard Street (Continued)), the reader encounters the unmistakable voice and structural rigor that earned Lombard Street its stature in the Monetary History & Central Banking canon. Where superficial treatments settle for isolated maxims, Walter Bagehot traces the deeper causal connections linking premise, observation, and conclusion.

As this section draws toward its close, the groundwork is laid for the subsequent movements of the volume. Readers studying this edition in the Folio Digital Library may bookmark this chapter, adjust typographic contrast and font sizing, or download the complete archival PDF, EPUB, HTML, or Plain Text edition for offline study.

CHAPTER III

How Lombard Street Came to Exist

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CHAPTER VI

Why Lombard Street is Often Very Dull, and Sometimes Extremely Excited

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CHAPTER VII

A More Exact Account of the Mode in Which the Bank of England Has Discharged Its Duty

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